

Figure 6.1.1: Will they fire more staff in the next 2 months - across survey phases (%)

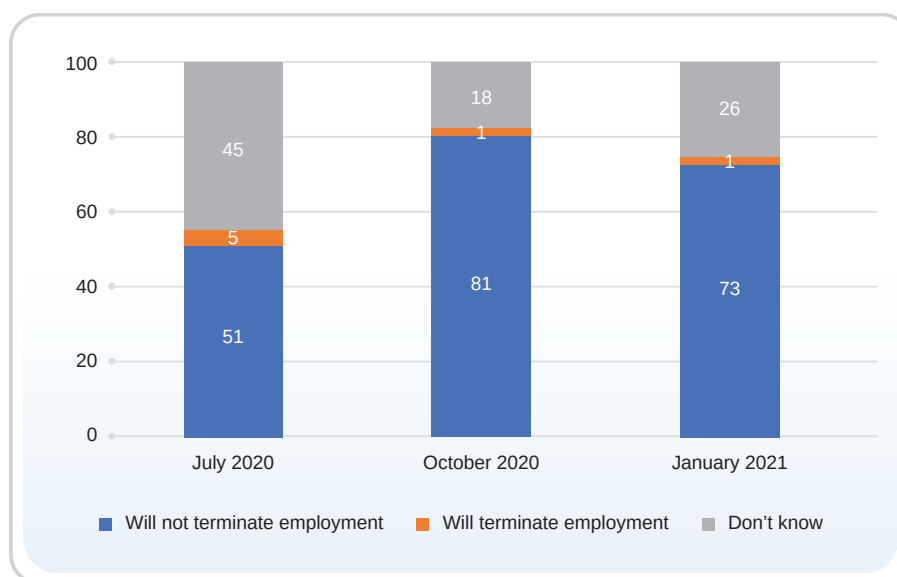
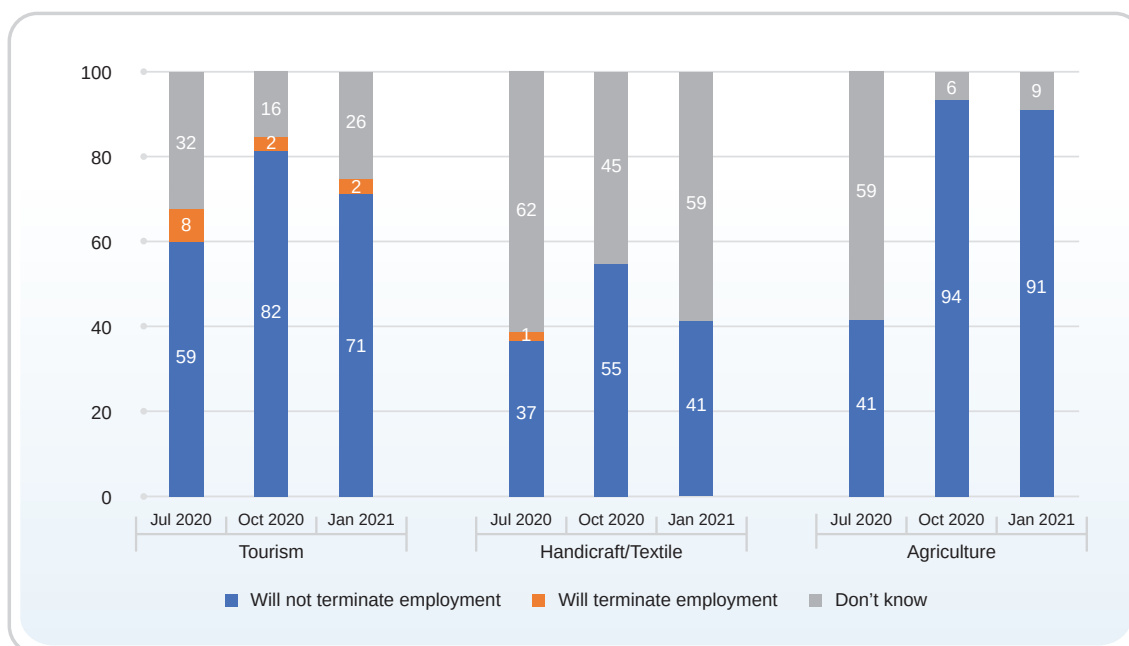


Figure 6.1.2: Will they fire more staff in the next 2 months – across sectors and survey phases (%)



6.2. Expectations for Re-Hiring Employees

In July 2020, 81% of the MSMEs that had laid off employees expected to re-hire all of them when the situation improved. This number reduced to 23% in October 2020 and further to just 7% in January 2021.⁵ In July 2020, all MSMEs had plans to re-hire at least some of their staff. But in October 2020, 17% said

they had no plans to re-hire and another 36% said they didn't know whether they would re-hire or not. In January 2021, 20% said they had no plans to re-hire and another 27% said they did not know. This question was only posed to those who had let staff go since the last survey round, and in October 2020 and January 2021, the base numbers reduced as fewer MSMEs reported letting staff go. In July 2020, 195 MSMEs

5. The question on re-hiring was asked to those who had laid-off employees since the last survey. In the latter two survey rounds, respondents were asked about plans to re-hire staff whom they had let go since the previous interview, whereas in July 2020, they were asked about plans to re-hire staff they had let go since their business was first affected by the pandemic.